TEACHER PLUS ACTIVITIES

Teacher Plus Worksheet

Playsheet

AN INTRODUCTION TO BASIC CONCEPTS IN ART AND DESIGN

Lines

You may have heard the definition of a 'line' in your geometry class. Here is another one! ***"A path of a dot, point, etc., through space that always has more length than thickness."***

Lines can be varied, especially in art. A line can be horizontal, vertical, diagonal, zigzag, curved, wavy, spiral, long, short, thin, thick, dotted, dashed and a combination of several of these. Whoa! Isn't that great?

Practice some of these lines before you go on to take our challenge:

ZigZag	Wavy	Spiral	Curved	Diagonal

Activity 1: Ready for the challenge?
Fill the box below with several horizontal and diagonal black lines. But wait! The lines should not only be black, horizontal and diagonal but also wavy and thin. Sounds fun? All the best then!

A beautiful scene of group dance by men and women

Speaking of lines, have you ever seen a Mithila/Madhubani painting? It is a traditional form of painting practiced by the people of Mithila region in Bihar. Isn't it marvellous in its intricacy, detail and gush of colours? Among the distinguishing features of Mithila paintings are its borders. They too are super intricate, just like the rest of the painting!

Below is a set of eight sample borders that could be used for a Mithila Painting:

Activity 2: Now try completing the border below. As you see, this involves an intricate use of lines (horizontal, vertical and diagonal) Go ahead and add a dash of colour where and as you please!

MYOB Challenge! Make Your Own Border using horizontal, vertical, diagonal lines. Come on, go ahead and use some colours and curves too!

Rong Rongin: Step into the world of colours!

Here's something to whet your appetite...

- Nandalal Bose's preference for indigenous colours, paper and other art materials owed much to Mahatmaji's love for Swadeshi and Khadi. Isn't this an interesting example of how Gandhiji's political philosophy shaped a painter's approach to his art? Do you know of any other such artist? Emm, say Vishnu Chinchalkar? Go ahead, find out more.

- Abanindranath evolved a personal style, combining western drawing with eastern colour. Do you think some colours are more 'Indian'? Can you state a few, with your reasons for the same?

- Ramkinkar always delighted in experiment and even while watercolour and tempera were the usual techniques practiced, he often painted in oils. Ramkinkar was not just a painter but also a sculptor par excellence! Why don't you find out more? You will be transported to a magical world!

- Taikan's presence, gave Indian artists, especially Gaganendranath an opportunity to study and adapt some of the aspects of calligraphy and Japanese use of colour in their own work. Who was Gaganendranath? Was he related to Abanindranath and Robindranath?

- The pages of the Constitution of India were decorated with astonishing skill using indigenous techniques of applying gold-leaf and stone colours. Look it up on the World Wide Web. The Constitution of India was thus embellished by the artist laureate of the country. Who was this artist laureate who decorated our Constitution?

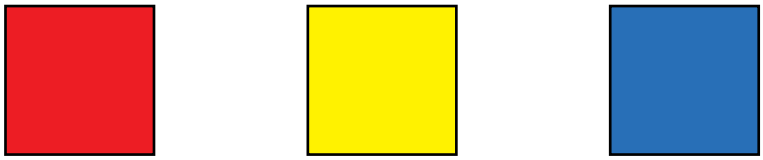
- There haven't been more than seven or eight colours in natural dyes, among them black, red, maroon, and yellow, said Toofan Rafai. What a name! Wondering who he was? Also, if you had to experiment with a natural ingredient and its colour, which ingredient would it be? Turmeric? Coffee? Beetroot? Pomegranate? Rose? Mehendi leaves? Gosh, the list can be really long....

- *Red is the laughter piled in Polash, Ashok/A red drunkenness marks the morning clouds/The new-born leaves are tinged with ripples of red.* Tagore was a writer first and a painter later. Here he describes a range of reds, from the vivid (Polash, Ashok) to the marginal (new born leaves tinged with red). Do you know of any other piece of writing that conjures up the richness of colour?

- Tagore always referred to his art as a playful activity, playing with lines, splashing about with colours. Nevertheless, the range of colours in his paintings is limited. They exhibit a 'restricted colour space', in consonance with what one might expect of a protanopic artist. Tagore was a Protanopic artist! It governed his palette very strongly, giving his paintings a unique look! Find out more about Protanopia!

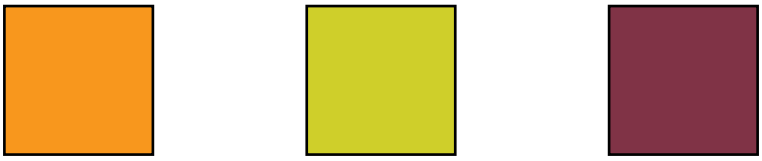
Let us now look at the basic qualities of this most wonderful element in art – colour!

Primary colours: The primary colours are red, yellow and blue. They are the first or main colours. They cannot be made by mixing other colours.

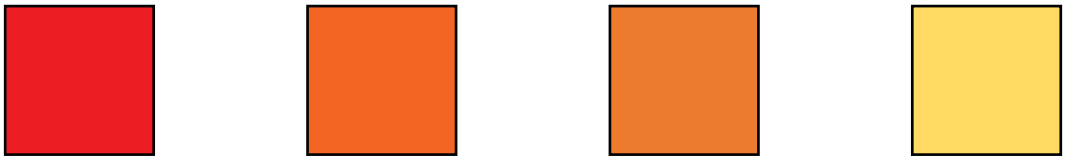


Secondary colours: The secondary colours are made by mixing together two primary colours. They are orange, green and purple, for example.

Tertiary colours: Tertiary colours are acquired by mixing primary and secondary colours.



Warm colours: Warm colours are often said to be hues from red through yellow, browns and tans included.

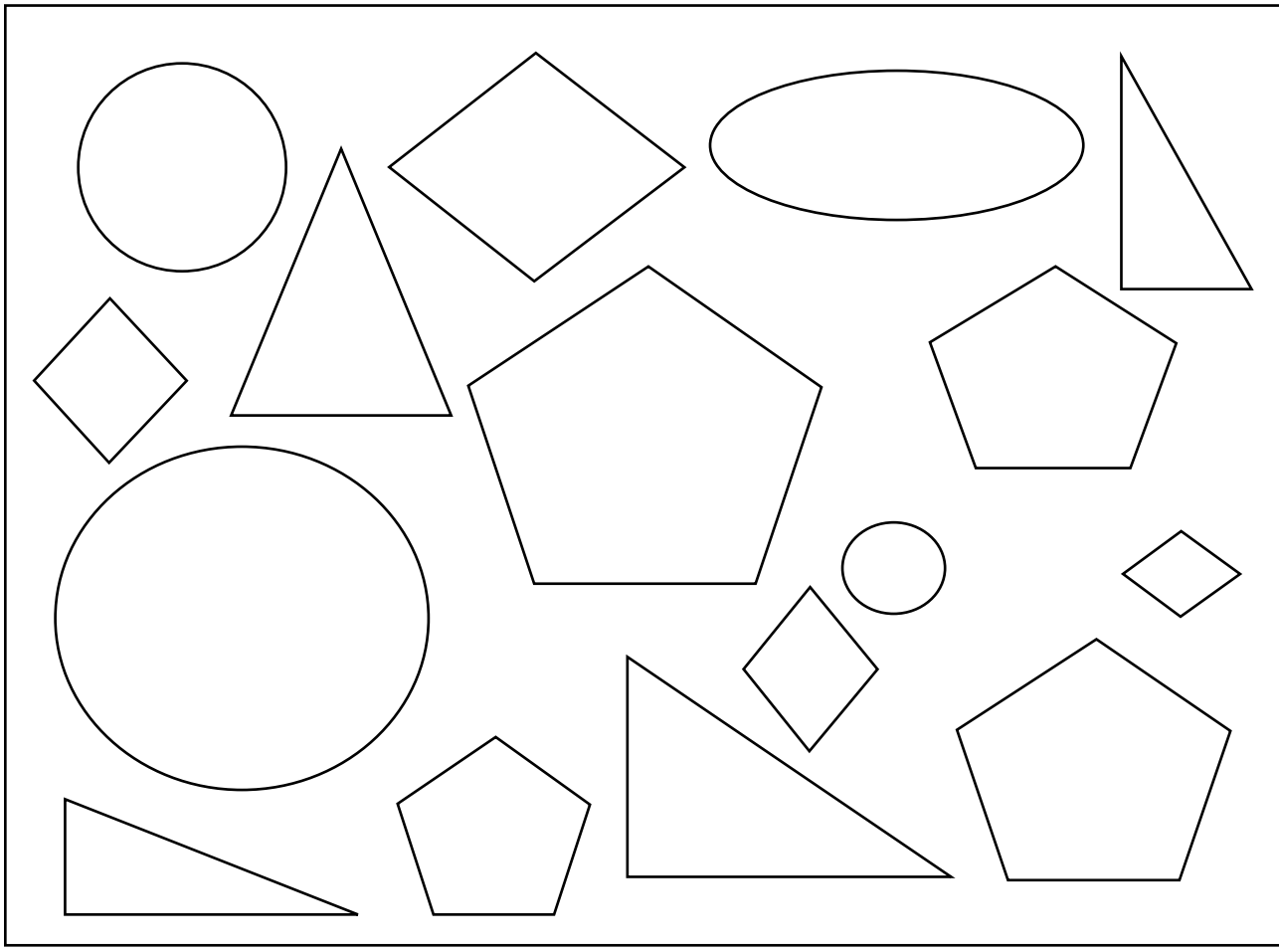


Cool colours: Cool colours are often said to be the hues from blue green through blue violet, most grays included.

Tint: When you add white to get light tones of a colour.

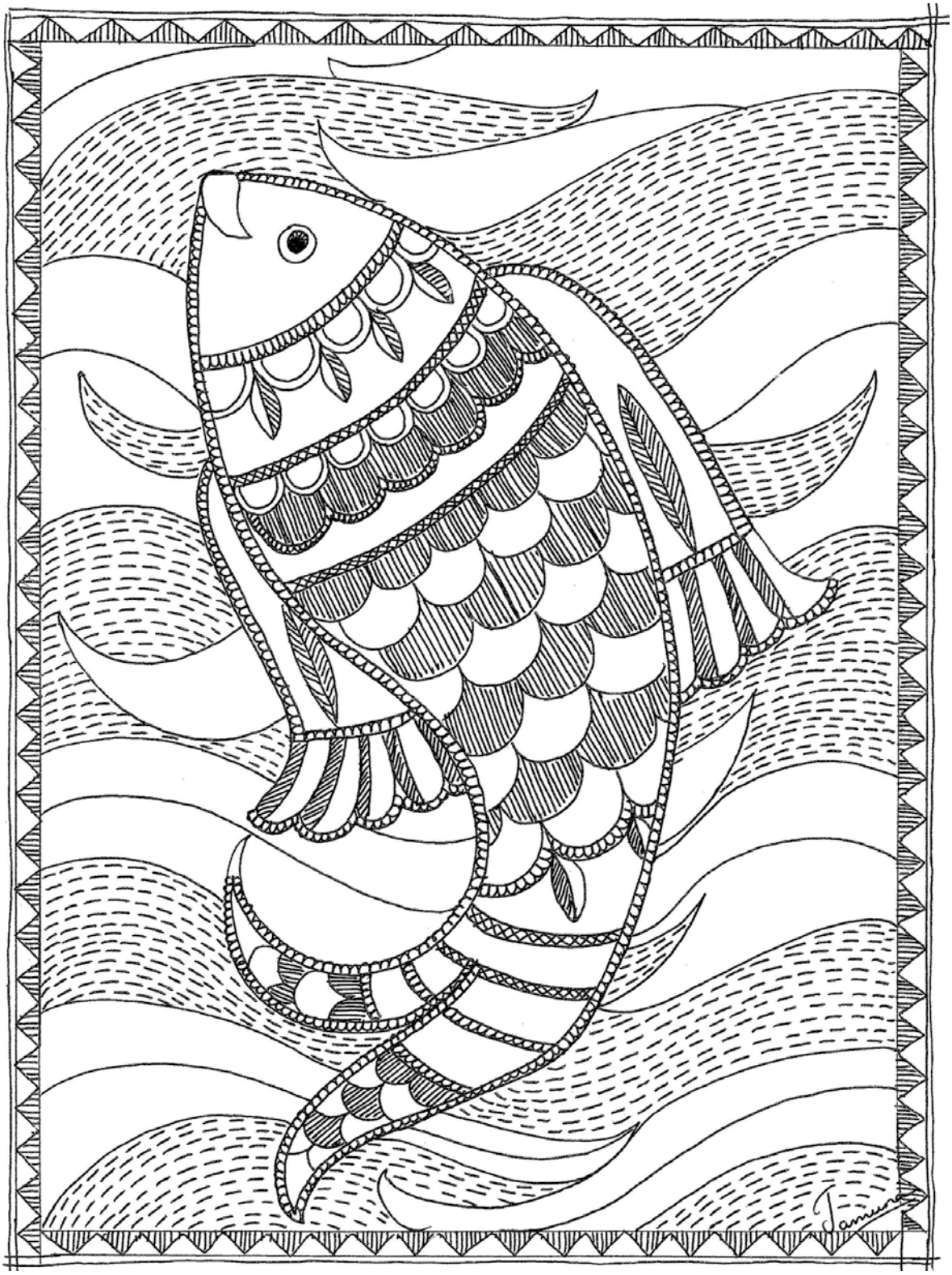
Shade: When you add black to get darker tones of a colour

Activity 3: Colour all pentagons in tints of red. Colour all circles in shades of blue. Colour all triangles in tints of brown. Colour all rhombus in shades of green.



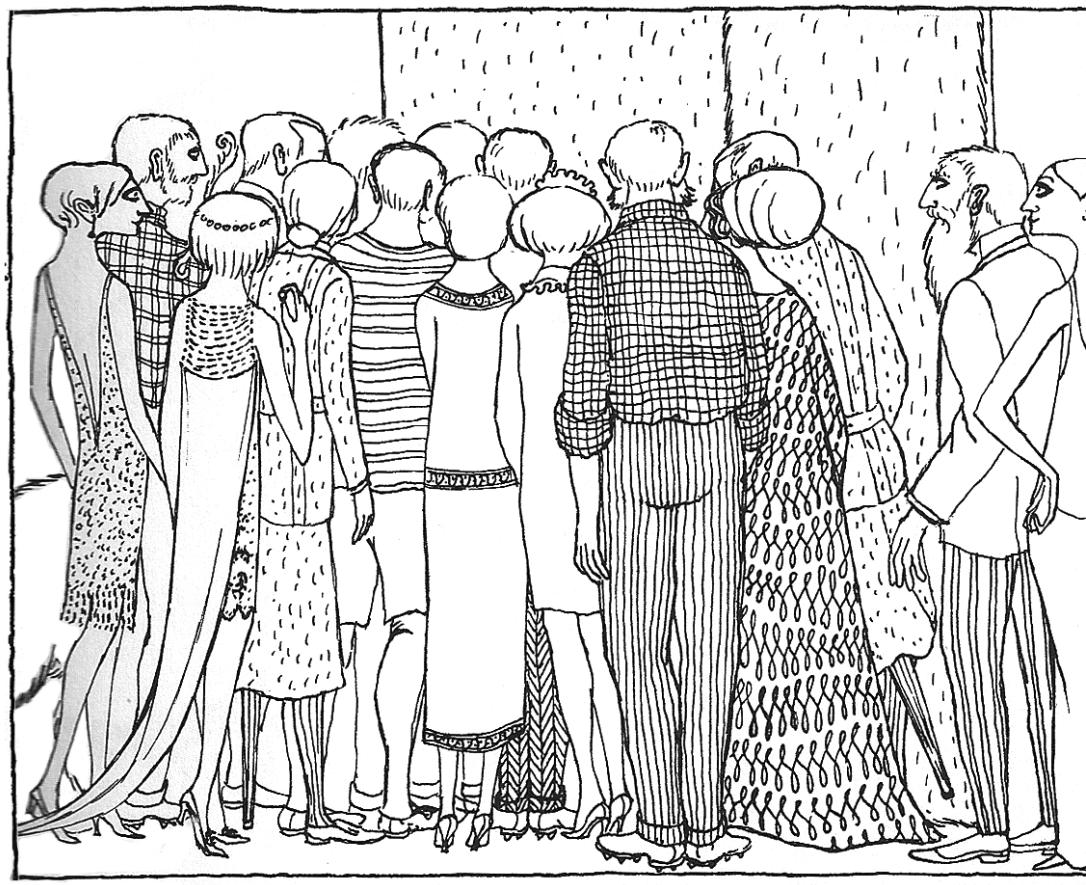
Activity 4: Did you know that fish hold a lot of significance in Mithila paintings? Oh yes, they do!

Paint this fish made in Mithila style! Use a combination of warm colours for the fish. Try and use primary, secondary and tertiary warm colours. Paint the water in the background using various cool colours. Once again, use primary, secondary and tertiary colours.



Texture: *Visual texture* is the illusion of having physical texture. Drawings and paintings use visual texture to portray subject matter realistically or as interpreted by the artist. Texture in drawings and paintings is generally created by the repetition of shape and line.

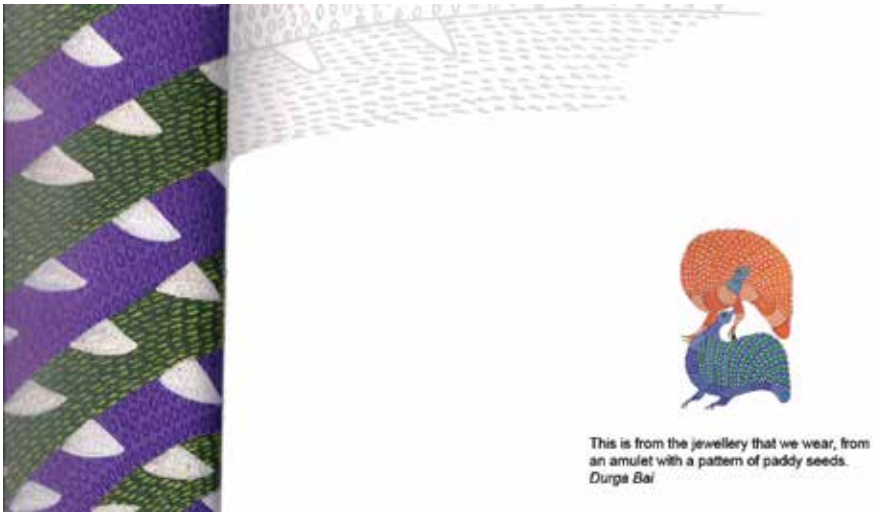
Edward Gorey Illustration



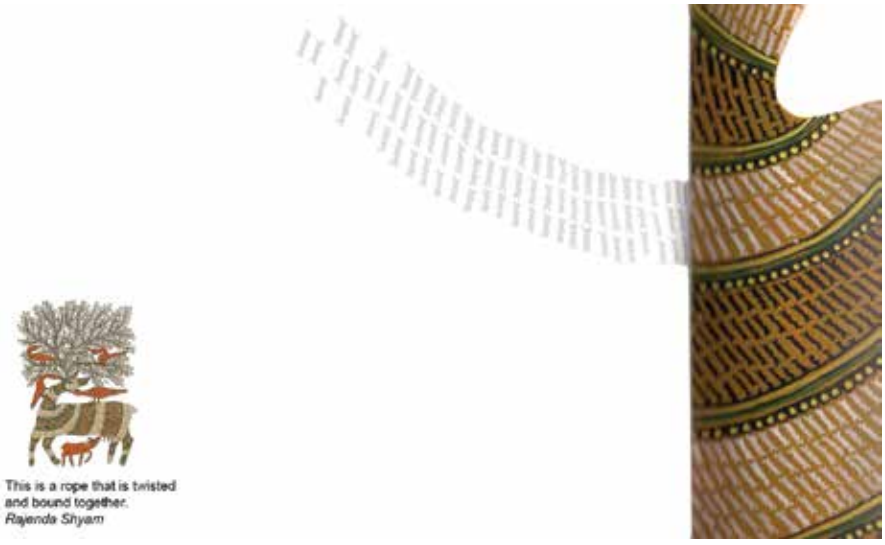
Activity 5: Look at the following boxes. Each box has the name of an object made of a particular material. Imagine the texture of that object and recreate in the box using lines, dots or whatever shapes you will.

Fish	Silk Scarf	Glue	Oil
Marble Floor	Tree Bark	Cactus Plant	Candy Floss

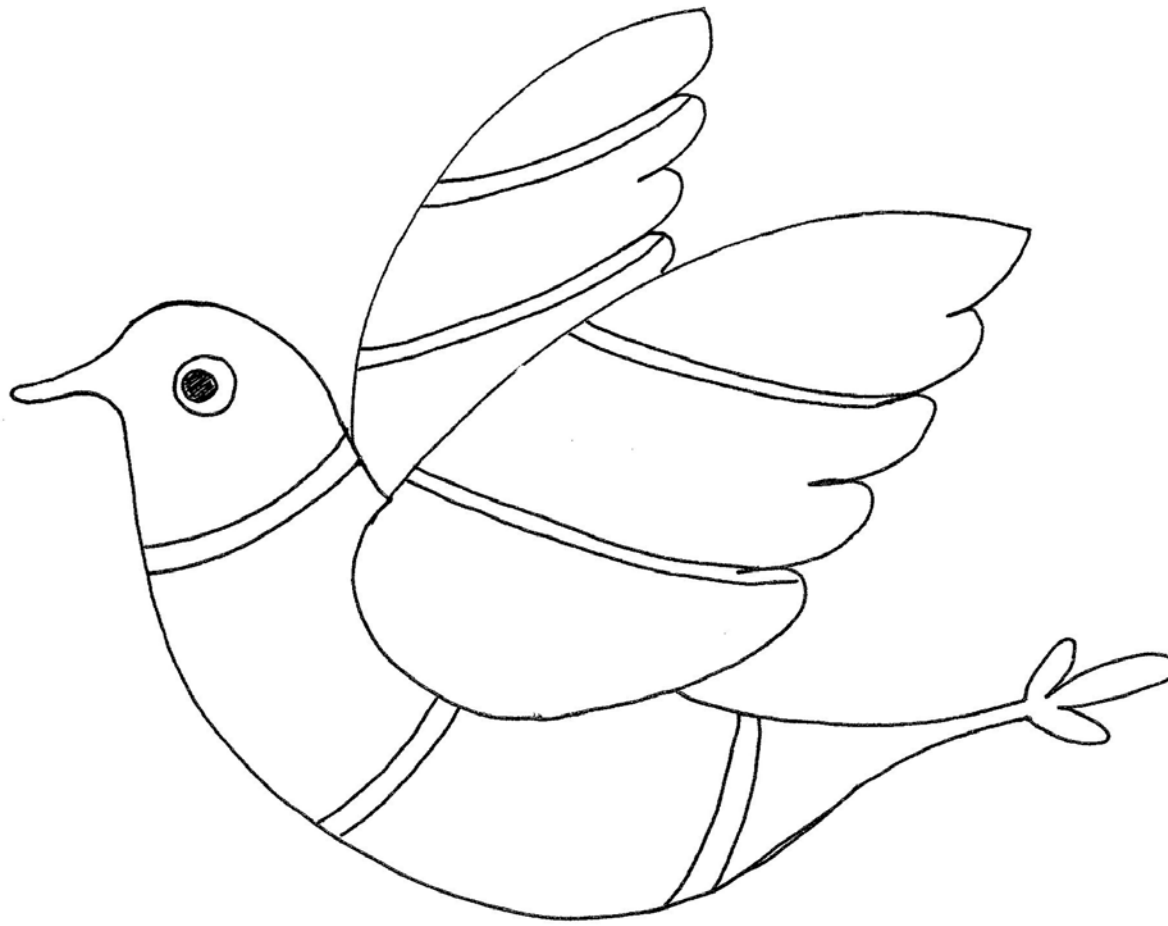
Rope	Hair	Dog	Water
Leaf	Skin	Coconut	Wood



Have you seen or heard about Gond paintings? They are paintings by Gonds, members of a tribe largely found in Central India. Gond paintings are rich with meaning, an expression of the people's oral culture, rituals, traditions and daily life. What makes their paintings unique is how they are packed with one or more decorative pattern/s usually comprising of dots, dashes, lines, circles, etc. Here are some examples:



Activity 6: Look all about you! What pattern appeals to you? It could be hidden in your piece of toast OR in your favorite sweater OR in your favorite fruit OR on the wing of that insect you found on the window sill OR in that leaf that got stuck in your hair.... Look! Look! And you will find a pattern that holds meaning just for you. Fill this little bird with the pattern of your choice.



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